

assurance. Videte miraculum is a graceful, six-part antiphon for the Virgin Mary, while the anthem If ye love me is a fine example of his simpler “reformed” style.

Tallis’s masterpiece, however, is the monumental Spem in alium, a motet sung by eight five-part choirs arranged in a circle. The audience sits in the center, as the voices eddy back and forth around them. There was a rumor that Tallis composed this extraordinarily intricate piece in response to a challenge from the duke of Norfolk, but this cannot be verified.



SCORE OF *CANTIONES SACRAE*

In 1575, the composers Thomas Tallis and William Byrd together published, under special license, *Cantiones sacrae* (Sacred Songs). The cover of the original manuscript is shown here.

In his later years, Tallis worked with his pupil William Byrd. The pair were granted an exclusive license by Elizabeth I to print and sell music, and in 1575 they produced a book of motets, *Cantiones sacrae* (Sacred Songs).